Kugonakwashe Taanarwo

History and international affairs graduate who finds, organises and analyses information, then turns it into clear recommendations.

Harare, Zimbabwe +263 783 732 103 ktaanarwo@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/kugonakwashe-taanarwo-489b002a3

I hold a BA Honours in Zimbabwean History and International Affairs from the University of Zimbabwe. I have researched a national institution across 44 years, kept library records at a Harare school for a year and completed Youth Service community training. I am looking for an entry-level role where careful research, reliable administration and good work with people matter.

What I bring

Research and analysis

Qualitative dissertation on Air Zimbabwe, 1980–2024, ending in practical recommendations on governance, planning and fleet renewal.

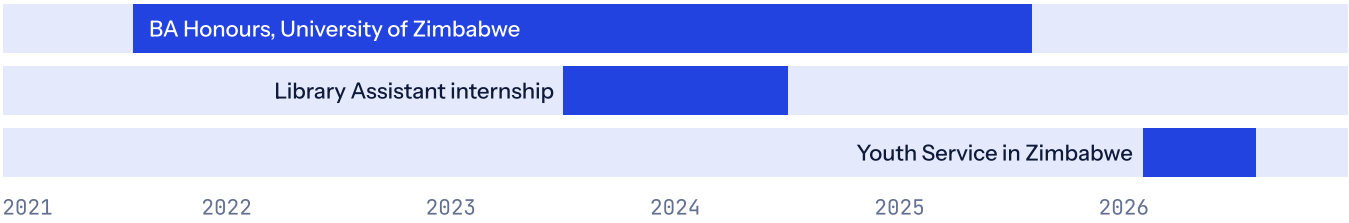
Records and administration

Catalogued resources, monitored a borrowing system and kept circulation records for a full year. Studied records and archives preservation.

People and communities

Supported teachers and learners daily, then trained in community engagement and took part in community development work.

RECENT TIMELINE



ROLES I AM SUITED TO

- Research assistant
- Programme assistant
- Administrative assistant
- Records or archives assistant
- Library or information assistant
- Community or youth programme officer
- Graduate trainee, public or private sector

IN THIS PORTFOLIO

KT/2 Research case study: Air Zimbabwe
KT/3 Experience and what it shows
KT/4 Education, credentials and references

KT/2 Research case study

Operational Challenges in the Aviation Industry: A Case of Air Zimbabwe (1980–2024)

TYPE	PERIOD STUDIED	METHOD
Honours dissertation, University of Zimbabwe	1980 to 2024, 44 years	Qualitative research

The problem

National airlines operate in a competitive and changing global industry, and their difficulties rarely have a single cause. I set out to explain the long-term factors behind Air Zimbabwe's performance and decline, and what could be done about them.

How I approached it

I traced the airline's history from 1980 to 2024, analysed information from relevant research sources and examined its institutional weaknesses through four lenses.

Historical legacies	What did the airline inherit, and how did it shape later performance?
Governance gaps	Where did the institution's structures and oversight need strengthening?
Political influences	How did politics affect the way the airline operated?
Economic pressures	Which economic conditions constrained its performance?

What I recommended

The dissertation closes with practical recommendations in three areas:

- **Governance improvements** to address the institutional weaknesses identified
- **Strategic planning** for a competitive and evolving sector
- **Fleet renewal** as a route to operational improvement

WHAT THIS SHOWS AN EMPLOYER

- I can manage a long, independent research project through to a finished piece of work.
- I can look past symptoms and explain how history, politics, money and management interact inside an organisation.
- I can move from analysis to practical recommendations, the same step needed in reports, policy briefs and programme reviews.

Experience and what it shows

Library Assistant, Education Internship

Jul 2023 – Jul 2024

Queen Elizabeth High School, Harare

WHAT I DID	SKILL IT SHOWS
Organised and catalogued books and educational resources	Information management
Monitored the borrowing system and kept circulation records, helping materials move smoothly	Record keeping and accuracy
Helped teachers and students find research materials for coursework, debates and projects	Research support and service
Supported the preparation of reading lists and resource packs for History and Social Studies	Preparing useful documents
Gave academic and research support to learners working on national and international issues	Communication and mentoring
Kept the library orderly and accessible for independent reading and research	Organisation and reliability

Youth Service in Zimbabwe, Community Service

Feb 2026 – Aug 2026

Dadaya Youth Service Training Centre

WHAT I DID	SKILL IT SHOWS
Took part in community service and development activities	Community engagement
Completed structured training over six months	Discipline, teamwork and leadership
Trained in basic ICT, environmental management and community engagement	Practical and digital skills

WORKING STRENGTHS

Report writing and documentation · Online research tools · Filing and office coordination · Stakeholder service · Handling information responsibly · Working alone or in a team · Time management

Education, credentials and references

BA Honours in Zimbabwean History and International Affairs 2021 – 2025

University of Zimbabwe, Faculty of Arts and Humanities

Degree awarded 30 July 2025. Research focus area: Operations of the Aviation Industry.

COURSEWORK AND WHERE IT APPLIES

COURSE	USEFUL FOR
Preserving Records and Archives	Records and archives work
Historiography and Historiographical Traditions	Weighing sources and evidence
African Political Ideas	Policy and governance
Europe in History and Global Affairs	International relations
Land and Environmental History of Sub-Saharan Africa	Development and environment

CERTIFICATES AND LICENCES

- Youth Service in Zimbabwe Certificate, 2026
- National Foundation Certificate in Cabinet Making, 2018
- Clean Class 4 driver's licence, obtained 2019

AVAILABLE ON REQUEST

- Certified copy of degree certificate
- Copies of certificates and licence
- Dissertation for review

REFERENCES AND CONTACT

Academic and workplace references are available on request.

Kugonakwashe Taanarwo +263 783 732 103 ktaanarwo@gmail.com